Week 2 | Real-book guide

October 19 to 23 | A difficult problem changes when everyone works together.

One book, all subjects

Big Pumpkin | A difficult problem changes when everyone works together. Math: Share pumpkin counters or seeds into equal groups and represent the groups with the week's operation. Science: Use a toy pumpkin or car to show how a push or pull changes position and motion. Social studies: Match each character to a team role and explain how cooperation helps the group. Finish: Create a lift-the-pumpkin paper chain showing each helper in order.

Grade 3 | Big Pumpkin

Erica Silverman | Picture-book fiction

Prepare

one copy of Big Pumpkin; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket Use selected scenes from Big Pumpkin to teach both learners. Their TEKS targets are different, but the read-aloud, page evidence and shared discussion are the same.

2026-10-19: Answer a who, what, where, when, why or how question about the story. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-10-20: Identify what happens at the beginning, middle and end of the story. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-10-21: Identify the story problem and the action a character takes. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-10-22: Retell the important events in order using three picture cards. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

2026-10-23: Explain how a character's action changes what happens next. (TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Grade 4 | Big Pumpkin

Erica Silverman | Picture-book fiction

Prepare

one copy of Big Pumpkin; scene props or picture choices matched to the selected page; response frame; finished basket Use selected scenes from Big Pumpkin to teach both learners. Their TEKS targets are different, but the read-aloud, page evidence and shared discussion are the same.

2026-10-19: Answer a why or how question and cite the illustration or page that supports it. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-10-20: Explain the story problem, important action and resolution using page evidence. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-10-21: Explain how two characters interact and how that affects the plot. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-10-22: Analyze the sequence of events and identify the turning point. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

2026-10-23: Use a detail from the story to explain a character's choice. (TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C)

Teach from the actual pages

Read a short section aloud. Think aloud and point to evidence (I Do). Act or sequence it together, then return to the page (We Do). Ask a fresh question and collect the planned response (You Do).

Book access

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